

ORGANIC GARDEN

Gardening Quality & Grading Cheatsheet

This cheatsheet outlines the quality standards and grading systems used at **Organic Garden** to ensure high-germination rates, bio-active soil potency, and healthy nursery transplants. Use these grades to evaluate and monitor your own garden materials.

1. Seed Germination & Quality Grading

Grade	Criteria / Sourcing	Target Germination	Best Use Cases
Grade A (Premium)	100% Certified Organic, heirloom, non-hybridized, non-GMO. Open-pollinated, harvested from heirloom fields.	95% – 99%	Urban containers, balcony beds, beginner growing.
Grade B (Standard)	Certified organic, untreated, may include F1 hybrid seed lines for specific disease resistance.	85% – 94%	Standard backyard garden plots, raised beds.
Grade C (Commercial)	Bulk untreated seeds. Selected for large-scale yield but has lower germination guarantee.	75% – 84%	Large acreage crops, cover crop seeding, microgreens.

2. Soil & Organic Compost Potency Grading

Grade	Texture & Aroma	Bio-Active Quality	Recommended Use
Grade A (Premium)	Rich humus scent, light spongy loam. High water retention without compacting.	Rich in earthworms, mycorrhizal fungi, and coco-coir. pH: 6.2 – 6.8.	Seed starting, delicate flowers, potting containers.
Grade B (Standard)	Earthy smell, moderate loam with fine compost mulch. Good drainage.	Standard microbial flora, fortified with aged animal manure. pH: 5.5 – 7.5.	Outdoor raised beds, shrubs, vegetable gardens.
Grade C (Sub-Soil)	Slightly compact, higher clay or sand ratio. Neutral or missing organic aroma.	Low microbial activity, requires organic amendments (compost, peat). pH: 5.0 – 8.0.	Ground filler, foundation landscaping, lawn leveling.

3. Live Plant & Seedling Vigour Grading

Grade	Foliage & Stems	Root Ball Health	Acclimation Level
Grade A (Nursery)	Vibrant green foliage, 5+ active growth shoots, strong main stem, pest-free.	Fibers well-distributed, not root-bound. Moist and fully aerated soil.	100% Acclimated to indoor climates; immediate display.
Grade B (Growing)	Healthy foliage, standard stem thickness. 2-3 active growing buds.	Slightly root-bound; standard soil pack.	Semi-Acclimated ; requires indirect sunlight for 3-5 days.
Grade C (Propagation)	Young seedlings or rooted cuttings. Single stem, delicate leaves.	Very young roots, requires gentle potting soon.	Non-Acclimated ; requires greenhouse dome or intensive care.